

Charcuterie shopping list for 40 people

Tick it off at the store. Amounts for all three ways of serving.

HOW MUCH TO BUY

BUY	APPETIZER	PARTY SPREAD	MEAL
☐ Cured meat	5½ lb	8¼ lb	11 lb
☐ Cheese	5½ lb	8½ lb	11 lb
☐ Crackers and bread	240–320	400–480	480–600
☐ Fresh and dried fruit	5½ lb	8¼ lb	11 lb
☐ Nuts	1½ lb	2¾ lb	2¾ lb
☐ Olives and pickles	2¾ lb	4¼ lb	5½ lb
☐ Spreads and honey	4 kinds	4 kinds	4 kinds

Per guest: 2 oz each of meat and cheese before a meal, 3 oz as the party food, 4 oz as the meal. +10% from 20 guests.

YOUR PICKS

Cheeses (5–6)

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Fruit

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Spreads (4)

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Meats (4–5)

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Crackers and bread

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Nuts, olives and pickles

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Party plan for 40 people

A grazing table, or three stations.

TIMELINE

- ☐ **1 week before**
- Order large pieces from the deli or warehouse store, and borrow extra boards or platters.
- ☐ **2 days before**
- Buy the cheese, meat and fruit. Buy crackers and nuts too.
- ☐ **The night before**
- Cut the firm cheeses and portion everything into containers, one set per station and one set for the refill. Cover and chill.
- ☐ **1 hour before**
- Take the aged and firm cheeses out so they can warm up. Leave soft cheese like brie in the fridge for now.
- ☐ **30–45 minutes before**
- Take out soft cheese like brie (it needs only 20–30 minutes), then build the stations: cheese first, then meat, then bowls, crackers and fruit.
- ☐ **While it's out**
- Swap in the fresh, fridge-cold refill before any tray has been out 2 hours.

SETUP

A grazing table, or three stations. Split the food into identical stations so guests don't queue at one end.

ROUGH COST (FOOD ONLY)

LEVEL	APPETIZER	PARTY SPREAD	MEAL
Budget	\$120–\$160	\$180–\$240	\$240–\$320
Standard	\$200–\$280	\$300–\$420	\$400–\$560
Splurge	\$520–\$800	\$780–\$1200	\$1040–\$1600

Estimates scaled from the boards in our book. Store, region and season change the total.

THE FULL PLAN: BOARD #49 IN THE BOOK

The Showstopper Grand Board

Exact shopping list with amounts and prices, a timed build, where every item goes and why, and a swap for every ingredient. 50 boards for \$14 (ebook) at charcuterielab.com/ebook